



<https://africanjournalofbiomedicalresearch.com/index.php/AJBR>

*Afr. J. Biomed. Res. Vol. 27(4s) (December 2024); 18681-18688*

Research Article

# The Peth (Nashik) Revolt Of 1857: Its Significance And Role In India's Freedom Struggle

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Acceptance - 04/11/2024

Received- 15/10/2024

DOI:10.53555/AJBR.v27i4S.8862

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During the early colonial period, India experienced political instability due to the decline of the Mughal Empire, as regional powers like the Marathas, Nawabs, and Rajputs sought to consolidate authority, often through conflicts that deepened fragmentation. The British East India Company exploited this situation, intervening in local politics under the guise of protecting commercial interests. Through alliances with rulers and victories in key battles such as Plassey (1757) and Buxar (1764), the British gained control over Bengal, Bihar, and Odisha, gradually consolidating power. Their "Divide and Rule" policy leveraged existing rivalries to strengthen colonial authority. Traditional administrative structures were weakened as local kings and zamindars became dependent on the British for revenue and governance, while the economy suffered. Over time, this dominance sparked widespread resistance across social classes and regions, laying the foundation for a sustained struggle for independence and fostering national consciousness and unity among the Indian people. The contribution of various regions and communities to India's freedom movement has been particularly noteworthy. The Peth region, located near Nashik in Maharashtra, also played a significant role in this struggle. In response to the oppression, exploitation, and repressive policies of the British administration, the people of Peth organized themselves and mounted a resistance that added momentum to the national movement.

Peth is a region enriched with rural and tribal cultural traditions. During the British colonial period, the Janjati farmers, laborers, and common people of this

area were burdened with excessive taxation. Under unjust colonial policies, their traditional rights over forests, land, and water were systematically taken away. In response to these oppressive measures, the people of Peth expressed their resentment through organized uprisings in the year 1857. These revolts rooted in agrarian exploitation and the imposition of heavy land revenue infused new energy and direction into the broader struggle for independence.

The contribution of the Peth uprising to India's freedom movement is of great historical significance. This struggle was not merely an act of resistance against British rule; it was a determined and collective endeavour aimed at establishing the ideals of freedom, equality, and self-respect. The revolt of Peth stands as an inspiring chapter in the history of India's independence movement, continuing to strengthen our national consciousness even today.

The objective of this research essay is to analyze the historical, social, and geographical dimensions of the Peth region, in order to understand the nature and extent of its significant contribution to the Indian freedom struggle.

## **Geographical background of Peth (Nashik)**

The Peth region constitutes an important part of the Nashik district and stands out distinctly from other subdivisions due to its unique geographical and natural characteristics. In terms of landscape and climate, Peth closely resembles the Konkan region. It is encircled by long chains of hills and valleys carved out by rivers

cutting through deep gorges. Several mountains in this area are even higher than the neighboring ranges of the Sahyadri. The average elevation of Peth lies about 600 feet below the Deccan plateau.

This region is covered with dense and rich forests. Although the trees here appear relatively short in height, high-quality teak wood is found in abundance in many parts. Agriculturally, the valleys are primarily devoted to paddy cultivation, while the hill slopes support the growth of nagli (finger millet) and other coarse grains. When viewed from the summits of the Sahyadri, the valleys of Peth resemble the rising and falling waves of the sea. The lush green patches of forests scattered among these valleys enhance the natural beauty of the Dāng region. Moving eastward, the elevation of the valleys gradually decreases. Except for a few months, the shedding of teak leaves renders the landscape sparsely vegetated for a brief period.<sup>i</sup>

The Peth–Surgana region is situated at an elevation of approximately 2,000 to 3,000 feet above sea level. The southeastern and eastern portions of this area are characterized by sloping terrain, while the Satmala, Chandore, and Ajanta mountain ranges extend from west to east. In the period when Nashik district had not yet been separated from Ahmednagar, these very mountain ranges served as the natural geographical boundaries dividing Ahmednagar and Khandesh. From a geographical standpoint, the region is divided into three distinct zones— Dang, Baglan, and Desh. The western section is known as “Dang,” the northern portion as “Baglan,” and the eastern area as “Desh.” The term *Dang* denotes a densely forested mountainous region. Stretching eastward from the Sahyadri range, the Dang tract spans, in several places, only about ten miles in length and thirty miles in width. Its defining features remain largely uniform throughout—steep hills carved by riverine erosion and extensive forest cover constitute the dominant characteristics of this landscape.<sup>ii</sup>

#### **Geographical Landscape of Baglan and Peth (Nashik)**

In the Baglan region, as one moves northward along the Satmala hills, the height of the Sahyadri peaks gradually begins to decline. The Girna River and its major tributaries have carved vast valleys across this area. Numerous minor rivers and streams descending from the surrounding hills continually feed the Girna, sustaining its flow throughout the year. South of the Satmala range lies the Dang region, which appears relatively more open in comparison. Based on the geomorphology, the land here is distinctly divided into hilly or *Dangi* terrain and flat or *Deshi* plains.

The western parts of Nashik, Peth, Dindori, Kalwan, and Baglan, which lie within the Sahyadri tract, are commonly classified as hilly or *Dangi* land. Owing to the poor soil quality, agricultural production in this region remains limited. Except for paddy fields, most lands must be left fallow for four to five years after

cultivating two successive crops. Agriculture here is predominantly rain-fed, and excessive rainfall combined with low soil fertility makes farming particularly challenging. Since much of the region consists of hills and slopes, cultivation is carried out with restricted resources. The soil in the Dang region is extremely shallow, compelling the local population to rely largely on shifting cultivation practices.<sup>iii</sup>

The land in the eastern part is considerably more fertile than that of the hilly regions. The soil here is predominantly black and rich, which enhances the prospects for agriculture. A range of the Sahyadri Mountains extends northward from the Western Ghats. Owing to these hills, the valleys of the Daman Ganga and Par rivers—located roughly twenty miles inland from the seacoast—are naturally separated from each other. The passes and mountain routes of the Sahyadri exhibit a variety of rock formations. These high ridges contain deep valleys that support the growth of high-quality teak forests.<sup>iv</sup>

As one descends from the highlands, the terrain gradually becomes more level, and these plains are predominantly used for paddy cultivation. During the British period, a variety of rice types was grown in the valleys of the Peth region. In contrast, the mountain slopes and ridges were primarily covered with the brown crops of ragi (nagali). Arable land in this region is extremely limited; most of the hilly tracts support only natural vegetation such as trees and grasses. Due to heavy rainfall, the soil on the slopes is frequently washed away and deposited in the valleys, gradually restricting agriculture to the lower, flatter areas. On the sloping lands, certain parcels are reserved for the cultivation of grains such as sawa, nivar, and nagali, as well as for grasses. In North Dang, this pattern is almost universally observed. Except for a few level tracts at the foothills, regular agriculture is rare. In many locations, cleared strips of land can be seen along the hill slopes, where nagali is cultivated. For this type of shifting cultivation, ash—produced by burning grass, leaves, and branches—is used as fertilizer. This practice loosens and enriches the soil, making it suitable for sowing crops.<sup>v</sup>

Numerous tribal communities inhabit the western hilly and remote regions of Peth, Surgana, Trimbak, Igatpuri, and Akole. During the colonial period, these communities led lives entirely dependent on nature. Subsistence agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting, and gathering of forest resources constituted their primary means of livelihood. Geographically, Surgana lies to the north of the Peth region, while Dindori and Nashik (the district headquarters) are situated to its east.

The history of these tribal communities is deeply intertwined with their geographical environment. Their social structures, cultural traditions, and lifestyles evolved in close alignment with the natural surroundings. Since ancient times, these communities have relied on agriculture, hunting, pastoralism, and

forest-based activities. Historical invasions and other significant events gradually pushed several tribal groups deeper into the forests, helping preserve many of their cultural traditions from external influences.

During the British colonial period, tribal communities were dispossessed of their traditional lands and resources. Increased government control over forests disrupted their traditional lifestyles and exacerbated socio-economic insecurities. After India gained independence, the Constitution granted special rights to tribal communities; however, even today, they continue to face numerous social, economic, and developmental challenges.

Thus, understanding the history of tribal communities necessitates a close examination of their geographical environment, natural resources, and traditional modes of living.

### **Early Tribes Life:**

The Peth Revolt was a significant popular movement carried out by tribal communities. To understand the background of this uprising, it is essential to study the history and social context of the tribal communities residing in Peth and its surrounding areas. The Nashik district has been home to a variety of tribal groups since ancient times. Detailed information on this is available in the *Nashik District Gazetteer* of 1883.

Based on the 1872 census, the Nashik District Gazetteer identifies the early tribal communities as Kolis, Bhils, Thakurs, Varlis, and Ramoshis. The Gazetteer notes: "*The early tribes, Kolis, Bhils, Thakurs, Varlis, and Ramoshis, are found in small numbers in most large villages, and form the bulk of the people in the wild western districts.*"<sup>vi</sup>

That is, tribes such as the Kolis, Bhils, Thakurs, Varlis, and Ramoshis were present in smaller numbers in larger villages, whereas they were found in greater concentrations in the forested western regions.

According to the 1872 census: Koli Mahadev - 68,620, Bhil - 30,178, Thakur - 8,954, Warli - 654. Thus, the total population of these tribes amounted to 108,402, which was approximately 17.61 percent of the district's total population at the time. In addition, a large number of Kunbi farmers resided in the forested areas. Here, the term "Kunbi" is used specifically in reference to the Konkan tribal community, as this group was considered more skilled in agriculture compared to other tribal communities. The combined population of the four major tribal groups Koli Mahadev, Bhil, Warli, and Konkan exceeded 25 percent of the district's total population at that time.<sup>vii</sup>

Tribes such as the Koli Mahadev and Bhil were traditionally recognized as martial and resilient communities. From the early period, these groups actively resisted British authority. Between 1818 and 1947, they participated in numerous uprisings against

colonial rule. The British administration implemented severe repressive measures to subdue them; however, these tribal communities continued their resistance. In the Peth Revolt as well, these tribes played a highly significant and decisive role.<sup>viii</sup>

### **Pre-Colonial Political Context:**

Significant details regarding the history of the Peth State are available in the 1883 Nashik District Gazetteer. According to this source, during the sixteenth century, Peth formed part of the Baglan State. Baglan appointed Kukaji Pawar as the *Kamavisdar* (administrative officer) for the governance of Peth. Kukaji changed his family surname from Pawar to Dalvi. The title "Dalvi" was a local designation in Baglan, meaning minister or administrator. Individuals in Baglan who held the office of *Kamavisdar* were commonly referred to as "Dalvi."<sup>ix</sup>

After the death of Kukaji, his son Bhikaji Dalvi assumed charge of Peth. Subsequently, Bhikaji's son, Krishna Dalvi, became the head of Peth under the Baglan State and assumed the title of "Raja." Krishna Dalvi had one illegitimate and two legitimate sons. Among the legitimate sons, the eldest, Ram Dalvi, was entrusted with the administration of the entire *pargana* except for the Harsul sub-division. The younger son, Bhikaji, was given Harsul, some fertile lands, and two villages in Dindori. Krishna Dalvi's eldest illegitimate son, Laxdir I, being the senior-most member of the family, was sent to Mulher in the service of the Baglan State along with a contingent of twenty-five cavalymen. After Krishna Dalvi's death, Laxdir I returned from Mulher and assumed control over the entire *pargana*, detaining his two brothers. Some time later, he released his brothers, and the three of them jointly administered the Peth State. During this period, Bhikaji Dalvi passed away.<sup>x</sup>

### **Mughal Period and the Revolt:**

In 1636, Baglan came under the suzerainty of the Mughal Empire. Refusing to acknowledge Mughal authority, Laxdir I, the *Kumavisdar* of Peth, rebelled against the Mughals. In response, Aurangzeb, the Subedar of the Deccan, dispatched his commander Sheikh Mansur to suppress Laxdir's uprising. Laxdir I valiantly resisted the Mughal forces for three consecutive years; however, he was ultimately captured through deceit. Lakshdir I, along with his wife, his son Kukaji, and his brother Ram Dalvi, was taken to Delhi and executed.<sup>xi</sup>

During the same period, one of Aurangzeb's daughters suffered from asthma. Ram Dalvi, who was a physician, successfully treated her. As a result, the death sentence imposed on the family was commuted; however, they were compelled to embrace Islam. Subsequently, their authority over the state was restored. Ram Dalvi was renamed Abdul Rahman, and Laxdir I was renamed Abdul Momin, also known as Lakshdir Dalpatrao.

### **Renaming, Division of the State, and Succession:**

Ram Dalvi was renamed Abdul Rahman, and Lakshdir I was renamed Abdul Momin, also known as Laxdir Dalpatrao. After returning from Delhi, Laxdir I had two sons—Chimanaji and Nanu Miyan. During his lifetime, Laxdir I divided the state into two parts: one portion for his sons and the other for the descendants of Ram Dalvi. Later, both Lakshdir I and Ram Dalvi were killed during a conflict with the Kolis at Mohri village in Dindori. They were buried at the same site, where their samadhis (memorials) were constructed.

Lakshdir's (Abdul Momin) three Muslim sons inherited half of the state, while the remaining half was given to the two Hindu sons of Ram Dalvi. Subsequently, Lakshdir II attempted to reunify the Peth State; however, during the reign of Peshwa Madhavrao Ballal, Peth came under the authority of the Peshwas. After several conflicts and political interventions, the Peshwas established their control over Peth.

### **Colonial Period:**

In 1818, the British defeated the Peshwa Empire. At that time, Laxdir III allied with the British, and in return, he was restored to power over the Peth estate. Thus, the administration of the Peth estate continued under British influence.<sup>xii</sup>

After 1818, Mount Stuart Elphinstone, the Commissioner of the Deccan, undertook the task of establishing the political and economic administration of the Deccan region. At that time, Nashik district was under the control of the Ahmednagar Collector. To oversee the administrative system of the area, Elphinstone appointed an officer named Henry Pottinger. During his tenure, Pottinger recognized the rights of minor kings and traditional local chiefs while simultaneously bringing them under the jurisdiction of British authority.

Through treaties and agreements with the Bhil principalities of Jawhar, Surgana, Peth, Ramnagar, Janjira, and Khandesh, these regions were brought under British control. In this process, Laxdir Dalpatrao supported the British, and as a result, the Peth estate was assigned to him. During this period, Lakshdir Dalpatrao entered into an agreement with Neelkanthrao, a Hindu branch ruler. According to this agreement, Neelkanthrao was promised an annual revenue of 2,000 rupees and the allocation of 24 villages with a total revenue of 1,500 rupees approximately one-third of his estate. This agreement was formally recognized by the British officer Captain Pottinger.<sup>xiii</sup>

In this context, Captain Pottinger's letter dated 7 May 1823 mentions this agreement. Furthermore, in a letter dated 23 September 1823, Pottinger specifically stated in paragraph six:

*"The agreement made with Neelkanthrao shall be*

*effective from the first day of the current fiscal year. However, naturally, nothing can be considered final until the question of revenue is settled and the ruler is provided with security."*<sup>xiv</sup>

This document is historically significant, as it not only validates the agreement between the Peth State and Neelkanthrao but also highlights the British policy of controlling local principalities and regulating the rights of traditional rulers.

### **British Control over Peth State and the Case of Neelkanthrao's 24 Villages**

In 1831, an official named H.G. Andrew wrote an important letter dated 19 December, in which he stated:<sup>xv</sup>

*"I wish to inform you that, in accordance with the instructions provided in your letter dated 1 December, one of my clerks, accompanied by a few sepoys, has been dispatched to the territory of Peth State. There, the 24 villages yielding an annual revenue of 1,500 rupees, as fixed by Mr. Reed on behalf of our government, will be taken under our control. Subsequently, these villages will be handed over to the representative sent by Raja Neelkanthrao. Additionally, I have personally instructed, both in writing and directly, Raja Neelkanthrao's son, Bhagwanrao, to send someone for this purpose."*

This letter clearly demonstrates that the British administration had begun the process of establishing direct control over the land and revenue of Peth State.

### **The 24 Villages Proposed to Be Assigned to Raja Neelkanthrao**

According to British records, the following villages of Peth Pargana were proposed to be assigned to Raja Neelkanthrao:

1. Mauje Ad Budruk
2. Mauje Ad Khurd
3. Majre Dolharmal Mauje Gonde
4. Mauje Kulvandi
5. Majre Sasune Mauje Kulvandi
6. Mauje Mankapur
7. Mauje Amblone
8. Majre Abheti Mauje Chalmukh
9. Mauje Piplvatti
10. Majre Palshi Mauje Chalmukh
11. Mauje Chalmukh
12. Mauje Gavandh
13. Mauje Nirgude
14. Mauje Bhuvan
15. Majre Sambar Pada
16. Mauje Kopurli
17. Mauje Umbarpada
18. Mauje Harangav
19. Mauje Khambashet
20. Mauje Tondval
21. Mauje Kumbhale
22. Majre Kahandulpada Mauje Kasur Vahir
23. Mauje Surgane
24. Majre Khadki Mauje Shruvan

After the death of Raja Neelkanthrao, his sons, Bhagwanrao Raja and Ramrao Raja, submitted a petition to the British government seeking the restoration of these 24 villages. However, the British administration rejected this petition.<sup>xvi</sup>

This petition is historically significant because it provides a clear account of the process through which Peth State came under British administrative control and the manner in which local authority was undermined.

British officer wrote to the Sub-Collector of Nasik District:

*"By the instructions of the Honorable Governor-in-Council, I am to inform you that in response to your recently received letter No. 452 concerning the late Raja Neelkanthrao of Peth, I am directed to notify you that the Governor-in-Council has approved your actions. With reference to the third paragraph of your letter, it has been concluded that you intend to grant Bhagwantrao only the policing powers within the boundaries of the villages assigned to him."*<sup>xvii</sup>

As a result of this decision, Raja Bhagwantrao's traditional revenue rights were revoked, and he was appointed solely as the head of police for the state. Thus, his economic and administrative authority was terminated, rendering him entirely dependent on the British government.

The British administration implemented a new land revenue system in the Peth estate and began levying additional taxes on the local population. The majority of residents in this region were tribal communities, whose economic conditions were already precarious. To pay the taxes, they had to rely on moneylenders, and gradually this system of indebtedness became an overwhelming burden. As a result, their lands were increasingly usurped by landlords and moneylenders. This situation led to growing discontent among the lower strata of society against the British administration.<sup>xviii</sup> In 1857, a widespread uprising against British rule erupted across India. In the Peth state, the anger of the local tribal communities also erupted. Symbolically, on 9 December 1857, revolutionaries from Peth, along with local residents, attacked the British treasury, marking the beginning of their rebellion against colonial authority.<sup>xix</sup>

### **Nature and Chronology of the Revolt**

During the Peth Revolt, British authorities received intelligence through the 9th Regiment. To suppress the uprising led by Bhaghoji Naik, Captain Nutal, a British officer on special duty, sent a letter from Trimbakeshwar to A. Bittington, Commissioner of Police, Pune. In the letter, he reported:

*"On 3 December, I set out from Akole via Samshherpur with a detachment of the Koli Levy (Deccan Koli Corps), but on the way, no information regarding 18685*

*Bhaghoji or his insurgents could be obtained."*

Subsequently, on the night of 6 December, it was reported that members of the Thakur community in Trimbak had plundered the British treasury. On 9 December, Captain Nutal arrived in Trimbak and successfully suppressed the rebellion by the Thakur and Koli communities.<sup>xx</sup>

However, on the evening of 12 December, news arrived that the people of Peth State had risen in rebellion and had plundered the village of Harsol. Captain Nutal immediately set out and reached Harsol on 14 December. Upon arrival, he observed that:

- The government police station and the houses of moneylenders had been looted.
- Official records had been torn apart.
- The munshi (clerks) and accountants were injured.
- The village mahajan (Bania) had been killed.

Captain Nutal remained in Harsol for a day or two and arrested several rebels. Among them, Bhau Gangaram Patil of Chinchwad village and Arjun Patil of Chhota Jategaon were prominent.<sup>xxi</sup>

The rebels advanced along the mountain paths and reached Pent, where the police were unable to stop them. The insurgents looted £300 (approximately 3,000 rupees) from the Peth treasury and proceeded toward a hill near the Dharampur boundary. Sometime later, a detachment of thirty soldiers from the Fourth Rifles, led by Lieutenant Glaspool from Dindori, arrived in Peth and arrested several members of the rebel group. In response, the rebels returned to Peth to free their comrades. Their numbers were several thousand, whereas the British forces were very few. The small British contingent was forced to take refuge within the walls of the government office and faced a siege. The following day, Baghaji Naik from Sinnar, along with approximately sixty men, joined the rebels. This further boosted the morale of the insurgents. In this situation, Lieutenant Glaspool relied on the government court complex for defense with his detachment.<sup>xxii</sup>

A loyal Maratha zamindar near Harsol informed Captain Nutal about the critical situation of the British forces. Captain Nutal immediately proceeded toward Peth. On the way, he observed that the passes leading to Peth had been blocked with strong barricades at four points. However, the rebels had not adequately defended these barricades, allowing them to be removed without significant difficulty. Upon reaching Peth at approximately five in the evening, Captain Nutal found Lieutenant Glaspool and his detachment of thirty soldiers safe, although they were nearly out of ammunition. At that time, the number of rebels was estimated to be between 1,500 and 2,000. That evening, the insurgents planned a new attack.<sup>xxiii</sup> Captain Nutal established a fortified position in Pent, but the rebels did not retreat. Subsequently, he advanced his forces and, after an intense confrontation, succeeded in defeating the insurgents.

### Suppression of the Rebellion:

On 19 December 1857, Captain Walker arrived in Peth from Surat with his battalion, along with a detachment of the 10th Regiment under H. B. Boswell. The British forces forcibly suppressed the Peth Rebellion. The principal leader of this uprising was Raja Bhagwant Rao, also known as Bhauraja. He, along with approximately fifteen of his followers, was captured and executed by hanging. Extensive details about the Peth Rebellion are available in British- era correspondence from Mumbai. According to Volume

20 of the 1858 Political Department records, the following information about the insurgents is noted:<sup>xxiv</sup>

- A total of 22 revolutionaries were arrested.
- Of these, 7 were sentenced to death by hanging.
- 4 were sentenced to life imprisonment.

This document clearly illustrates the severity of the rebellion from the perspective of the British administration and the methods employed for its suppression.

List of persons supposed to have taken an active part in the rising of *Peint* on and about the 9<sup>th</sup> December 1857. 25

|     |                         |                       |                                                    |
|-----|-------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1.  | Sadoo Sonar             | of Harsul             | At large                                           |
| 2.  | Futtey Mohamad          | naik of Peint         | At large with Bhagoji Bheel                        |
| 3.  | Natto Naik              | Sir naik of Peint     | hang                                               |
| 4.  | Dondia Bagul            | Naik of Peint         | hang                                               |
| 5.  | Shitara Naik            | Sir naik of Bare      | At large                                           |
| 6.  | Gat Patil               | Of Koombhale          | hang                                               |
| 7.  | Tukur Patil             | Of Karanjale          | Under trial for treason                            |
| 8.  | Bhau Malekar            | Naik of Sarusthe      | Awaiting trial                                     |
| 9.  | Tukaram Sirnaik         | Of Harsul mahal       | hang                                               |
| 10. | Bhau bin Gangaram Patil | Patil of Chancwad     | hang                                               |
| 11. | Arjun Patil             | of little Jategaon    | hang                                               |
| 12. | Manbhav                 | of Kumbharle          | Sentenced to 3 years imprisonment with hard labour |
| 13. | Sanu Bagul              | -----                 | Transported                                        |
| 14. | Vyankoba                | Custom Carcun         | At large                                           |
| 15. | Wajeerkhan              | Sepoy of peint police | Said to have shot at Mokhada                       |
| 16. | Mania Koli              | Of Harsul             | Transported                                        |
| 17. | Kalu bin Raja           | -----                 | Transported                                        |
| 18. | Dhondi Pradhan          | -----                 | At large                                           |
| 19. | Buia Gita               | -----                 | Awaiting trail                                     |
| 20. | Bhagwantrav Raja        | -----                 | hang                                               |
| 21. | Vithoba Diwan           | Diwan of Rani         | Awaiting trail                                     |
| 22. | Jagannath Taty          | Carcon                | Awaiting trail <sup>xxv</sup>                      |

### Progress of the Revolt (20–21 December 1857):

The day after Captain Walker's arrival, on 20 December 1857, Captain Nuttall marched southward with fifty policemen from Ahmednagar. On the following day, 21 December, around noon, they reached the village of Vasirhira, where approximately 500 rebels were gathered. Captain Nuttall, supported by fifteen soldiers from the Poona Horse Corps, launched an attack on the rebels. During this engagement:

- Eight rebels were killed,
- Ten were wounded,
- Three were captured.

During the confrontation, Captain Nuttall also engaged in close combat with Mahipati Naik, the brother of rebel leader Bhagoji Naik. In this encounter, Mahipati Naik was killed, and Captain Nuttall's horse sustained severe injuries.<sup>xxvi</sup>

This episode demonstrates that the rebels mounted an

organized resistance. However, due to the strategic maneuvers and superior training of the British forces, the rebels were compelled to retreat.

### Conclusion

The Peth Revolt, sometimes referred to as a local tribal uprising, was a significant movement against British rule in Maharashtra. The rebellion was not limited merely to resisting immediate oppression and exploitation; it represented a crucial struggle that awakened a sense of freedom, rights, and self-respect among the local tribal communities.

The British administration employed military force to suppress the uprising, arresting the rebels and imposing harsh punishments, including the execution of several key leaders. Following the revolt, the British tightened laws and administrative control, increasing surveillance over local tribal communities and farmers, thereby imposing additional social and economic pressures.

However, the impact of the Peth Revolt extended beyond the immediate circumstances. It inspired future movements and heightened awareness of rights and freedom among tribal societies. Although the British administration introduced some measures to regulate taxation and reduce local exploitation, these reforms were limited and largely temporary.

The Peth Revolt is remembered as an inspiring chapter in the history of India's struggle for independence. It demonstrates that local tribal communities could organize and mount effective resistance against injustice. While the rebellion ultimately ended in a British victory in the contemporary context, it significantly contributed to strengthening the foundations of India's broader freedom struggle.

#### **Notes and References**

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<sup>ii</sup> Ibid, pp.2-3.  
<sup>iii</sup> Ibid p.3.  
<sup>iv</sup> Ibid, pp.3-4  
<sup>v</sup> Ibid p.3  
<sup>vi</sup> Ibid, p.27.  
<sup>vii</sup> Ibid, p.60  
<sup>viii</sup> Dr. Gawari Vilas , *Vasahatik Maharashtraatil Adivasinche Uthav*, Hariti publication Pune, 2023, p. 20.  
<sup>ix</sup> Gazetteer of Bombay Presidency Nashik, Ibid, p. 384.  
<sup>x</sup> Ibid, p.385.  
<sup>xi</sup> Ibid, p.385.  
<sup>xii</sup> <sup>xii</sup> Ibid, p. 385.  
<sup>xiii</sup> Ibid, p. 387.  
<sup>xiv</sup> BA/PD, Volume 102/2108, year 1848, p.51.  
<sup>xv</sup> Ibid, p. 77.  
<sup>xvi</sup> Ibid, pp. M 75 and 313.  
<sup>xvii</sup> Ibid, pp. 127-28.  
<sup>xviii</sup> Ibid, pp.297-300.  
<sup>xix</sup> BA/PD, Volume 20, year 1858, p. M 311.

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- xxiii BA/PD, Volume 20, year 1858, p. M 101.
- xxiv Ibid, p. M 457.
- xxv. Gazetteer of Bombay Presidency Nashik, 1883, page 2.
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- xxv. Ibid 3-4.
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- xxv. BA/PD, Volume 20, year 1858, page M 311.
- xxv. BA/PD, Volume 22, year 1858, page M 401.
- xxv. BA/PD, Volume 20, year 1858, page M100.
- xxv. Gazetteer of Bombay Presidency Nashik, 1883, page 202.
- xxv. BA/PD, Volume 20, year 1858, page M 101.
- xxv. Ibid, p. M 457.
- xxv. Ibid, p. M457-58.
- xxv. Ibid, pp.M457-58.
- xxvi Ibid, p.M75.